

AI-Assisted Alert Triage Report – T1016

Incident Information

Field	Value
Atomic Test	T1016 - System Network Configuration Discovery
Wazuh Rule ID	92052
Alert Severity	Level 4 (Medium)
Detection Source	Sysmon Event ID 1 - Process Creation
Host	AmnaNaeem
User	AMNANAEEEM\amnanaeem
Detection Time	18 July 2026, 18:32:42 PKT

Executive Summary

A PowerShell process launched **cmd.exe**, which executed several Windows network discovery commands:

- `ipconfig /all`
- `netsh interface show interface`
- `arp -a`
- `nbtstat -n`
- `net config`

This behavior matches **System Network Configuration Discovery (MITRE ATT&CK T1016)**, where an attacker gathers information about network interfaces, IP addresses, ARP cache, NetBIOS configuration, and system network settings.

Although Wazuh generated an alert for **Windows Command Shell (T1059.003)**, the executed commands indicate a broader network reconnaissance activity consistent with the Atomic Red Team simulation.

Alert Details

Item	Value
Rule ID	92052
Rule Description	Windows command prompt started by an abnormal process
Rule Level	4
Event ID	Sysmon Event ID 1
Parent Process	powershell.exe
Child Process	cmd.exe
Integrity Level	High

MITRE ATT&CK Analysis

Wazuh Detection

Tactic	Technique	ID
Execution	Windows Command Shell	T1059.003

Human Verification (Correct Mapping)

The command executed was:

```
cmd.exe /c ipconfig /all & netsh interface show interface & arp -a & nbtstat -n & net config
```

These commands are reconnaissance commands rather than command execution for its own sake.

A more accurate mapping is:

Tactic	Technique	ID
Discovery	System Network Configuration Discovery	T1016
Execution	Windows Command Shell	T1059.003

Observation: Wazuh correctly detected the use of `cmd.exe` but did not identify the higher-level intent (network discovery). This is a good example of why human validation is important.

Evidence Collected

Parent Process

```
powershell.exe
```

Child Process

```
cmd.exe
```

Executed Command

```
cmd.exe /c ipconfig /all & netsh interface show interface &
```

```
arp -a &  
nbtstat -n &  
net config
```

User

AMNANAEEM\amnanaeem

Integrity Level

High

Indicators Observed

The process gathered:

- Network interface configuration
- IP address information
- ARP cache
- NetBIOS names
- Network configuration
- Network adapter status

These are common reconnaissance steps performed before lateral movement or further exploitation.

Security Analysis

The activity demonstrates **system reconnaissance**.

From a defender's perspective, this behavior could indicate that an attacker has already gained code execution and is collecting information about the environment.

In this case, however, the commands were intentionally executed through Atomic Red Team as part of a controlled security exercise.

Risk Assessment

Category	Assessment
Severity	Medium (Level 4)

Confidence	High
Malicious	No
False Positive	No
Expected Activity	Yes (Lab Simulation)

Recommended Analyst Actions

If this alert occurred in a production environment:

1. Verify whether the user intentionally executed these commands.
2. Review the PowerShell parent process to determine how it was launched.
3. Correlate with additional discovery or credential access activity.
4. Examine subsequent process executions for signs of persistence or lateral movement.
5. Investigate whether the reconnaissance was followed by suspicious network connections.

For this lab:

- Confirm that the commands correspond to the executed Atomic Red Team test.
- Record the alert as expected and generated during a controlled exercise.

AI vs Human Verification

Field	Wazuh Detection	AI Analysis	Human Verification
Rule ID	92052	92052	Correct
Severity	Level 4	Medium	Correct
Parent Process	powershell.exe	powershell.exe	Correct
Child Process	cmd.exe	cmd.exe	Correct
Executed Commands	Logged in Sysmon	ipconfig, netsh, arp, nbtstat, net config	Correct
Wazuh MITRE Technique	T1059.003 – Windows Command Shell	Identified as command execution	Correct but incomplete
Actual Atomic Test	Not shown in the alert	T1016 – System Network Configuration Discovery	Correct
Threat Classification	Suspicious command execution	Network discovery activity in a controlled lab	Correct
Analyst Verdict	Requires investigation	Benign (Atomic Red Team simulation)	Confirmed

Final Verdict

Classification: Benign (Controlled Lab Activity)

Reason: The observed behavior was intentionally generated by Atomic Red Team to simulate network reconnaissance. The commands executed (`ipconfig`, `netsh`, `arp`, `nbtstat`, and `net config`) are legitimate administrative tools frequently used by attackers during the discovery phase but were executed here for security testing.

Human Verification Note

The Atomic Red Team simulation executed technique T1016 (System Network Configuration Discovery). Wazuh generated an alert mapped to T1059.003 (Windows Command Shell) because its detection rule focuses on the execution of `cmd.exe` rather than the semantic intent of the executed commands. Manual analysis of the command line (`ipconfig`, `netsh`, `arp`, `nbtstat`, and `net config`) confirms that the underlying attacker behavior corresponds to T1016. This demonstrates that SIEM alerts often identify the execution mechanism, while analyst interpretation is required to determine the higher-level ATT&CK technique.